FOUR YEARS THAT SHAPED AMERICA

Donald J. Trump

The First Term 2017 – 2021

Background · Key events · Legacy

45

45th President of the United States



From Real-Estate Tycoon to the White House

45

45th President · 2017–2021

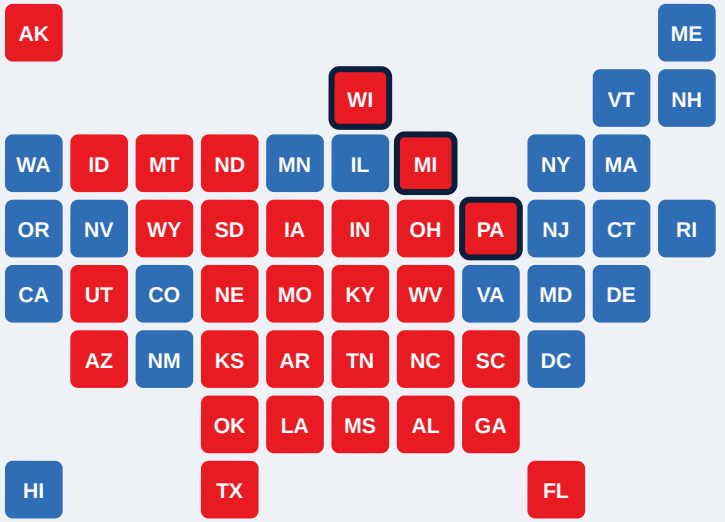
Vice President: Mike Pence

BORN	June 14, 1946, New York City
BUSINESS	Real estate · Trump Organization (from 1971)
TV	Host of “The Apprentice” (2004–2015)
CAMPAIGN	Republican · “Make America Great Again”
OUTSIDER	No prior political office or military service

2016 ELECTION · ELECTORAL VOTES

304–227

despite losing the popular vote by 2.9 million



Trump (R)
30 states

Clinton (D)
20 + D.C.

Rust Belt
PA, MI and WI: won by ~78,000 votes combined

Inauguration

2017 2018 2019 2020 2021

Taxes Down, Tariffs Up

TAXES DOWN

35% → 21%

Corporate tax rate · biggest tax overhaul since 1986 (Dec 2017)

TARIFFS UP

$370 billion

of Chinese imports hit by U.S. tariffs (2018–2019)

37%

top income tax rate (was 39.6%)

$1.5 trillion

added to the deficit over 10 years (Congress estimate)

$28 billion

in aid to farmers hit by China’s counter-tariffs

Jan 2020

“Phase One” deal: China pledges $200 billion in extra purchases

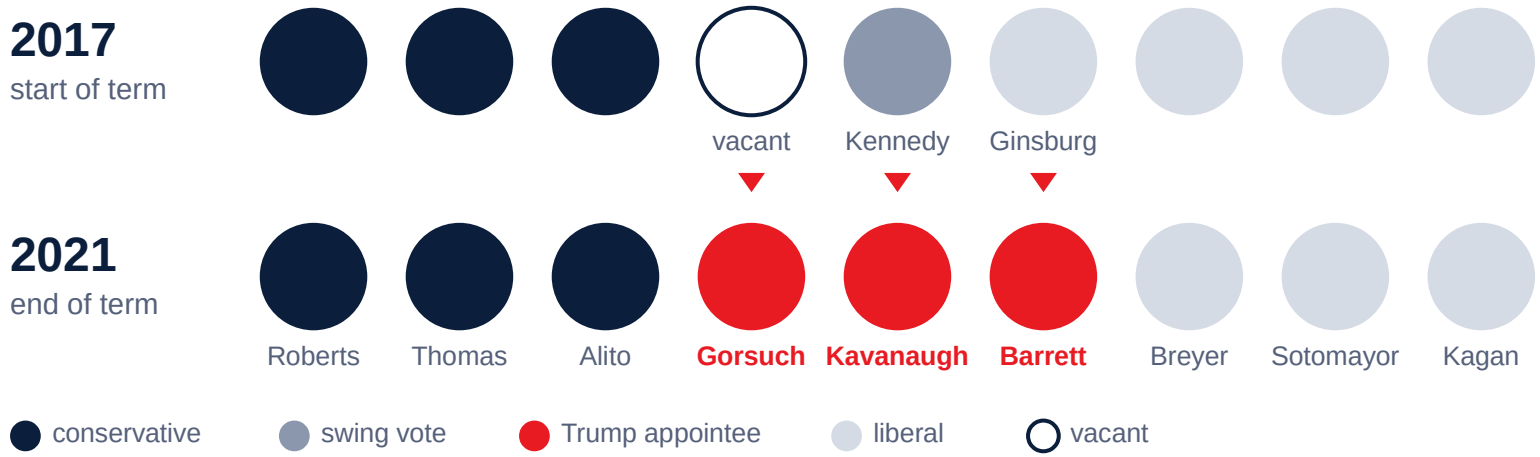


A Court for a Generation

SUPREME COURT · 2021

6–3

conservative majority · justices serve for life



234

federal judges appointed, all for life

Neil Gorsuch

2017 · SENATE 54–45

Took Scalia's seat, held open by the Senate in 2016.

Brett Kavanaugh

2018 · SENATE 50–48

Replaced swing vote Kennedy despite assault allegations.

Amy Coney Barrett

2020 · SENATE 52–48

Replaced Ginsburg 8 days before the election.



Hard Line at the Border, Going Solo Abroad

THE GUIDING IDEA

> *From this day forward, it's going to be only America first.*

Inaugural address, Jan 20, 2017

AT THE BORDER

7 countries

travel ban on mostly Muslim nations (2017)

35 days

longest shutdown in U.S. history, over wall funding

3,900+

children separated from their parents at the border

AROUND THE WORLD

Paris & Iran

exits from the climate accord and the Iran nuclear deal

North Korea

Kim Jong-un: first summit (2018), but no disarmament

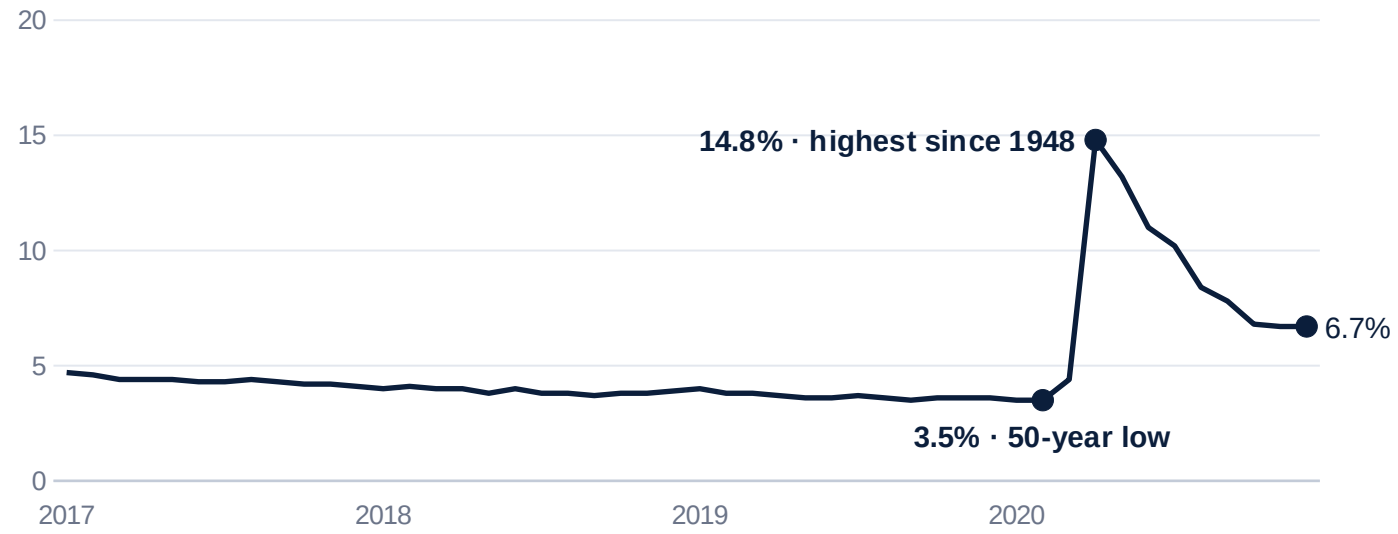
Middle East

Abraham Accords (2020): Israel opens ties with UAE and Bahrain



From Boom to Bust

U.S. unemployment rate (%), monthly



Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, seasonally adjusted

> *I wanted to always play it down.*
>
> Trump to journalist Bob Woodward, March 2020

$2.2 trillion

CARES Act (March 2020), the largest relief package in U.S. history

< 1 year

to the first approved vaccine (Operation Warp Speed)

400,000

COVID-19 deaths in the U.S. by the end of his term



06 · THE END · 2019–2021

Defeat and the Storming of the Capitol

2×

Impeached

a first for any president – acquitted both times

TRUMP'S SPEECH · JAN 6, 2021

"... peacefully and patriotically make your voices heard."

"We fight like hell."

Same speech – at the second impeachment trial, each side quoted one line.

DEC 18, 2019

1st impeachment

Pressure on Ukraine to investigate Biden. Acquitted.

NOV 3, 2020

Election lost

Biden wins 306–232 and by 7 million votes.

NOV–DEC 2020

Fraud claims

Refuses to concede; 60+ lawsuits fail.

JAN 6, 2021

Capitol stormed

Supporters break in; deaths, ~140 officers injured.

JAN 13, 2021

2nd impeachment

"Incitement of insurrection." Senate: 57–43, 67 needed.



07 · LEGACY

What Four Years Left Behind

THE LASTING LEGACY

6–3

A conservative Supreme Court for decades to come.

A DIVIDED NATION

41%

average approval (Gallup), the lowest ever. Yet 74 million votes in 2020, a record for an incumbent.

A NEW COURSE

America First

Tariffs, the wall, treaty exits: fewer agreements, more deals.

For discussion: Which decision from these four years will last the longest?

